

Training Modules

M1

ACADEMIC WRITING MASTERY

3 Sessions 9–
12 Hours

MODULE GOAL

To equip participants with the skills required to develop high-quality scholarly manuscripts that meet international publishing standards.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Structure a publishable academic manuscript
- Develop clear research arguments
- Write compelling abstracts and introductions
- Present findings effectively
- Select appropriate journals for publication
- Improve manuscript quality before submission

Session 1: Foundations of Academic Writing

Topics

- Characteristics of scholarly writing
- Research-to-publication pathway
- Understanding journal article structures
- IMRAD format (Introduction, Methods, Results and Discussion)

Practical Exercise

Analyse a published article and identify each section.

Session 2: Building a Strong Manuscript

Topics

- Writing effective abstracts
- Literature review development
- Constructing arguments
- Presenting methods and results

Practical Exercise

Participants draft an abstract from their own research.

Session 3: Journal Selection and Submission Readiness

Topics

- Identifying suitable journals
- Impact factors and journal rankings
- Avoiding journal mismatch
- Submission checklists

Practical Exercise

Match participant manuscripts to appropriate journals.

Assignment

Develop a complete manuscript outline for a selected study.

Expected Output

Draft manuscript ready for mentorship review.

M2

NAVIGATING THE PUBLISHING PROCESS

2 Sessions 6–8 Hours

MODULE GOAL

To prepare participants for successful engagement with editors, reviewers, and publishers.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Understand peer review systems
- Respond effectively to reviewers
- Manage revisions professionally
- Recognise predatory journals
- Understand publication workflows

Session 1: Understanding the Publishing Ecosystem

Topics

- Types of peer review
- Editorial decision-making
- Publishing timelines
- Rejection and resubmission strategies

Practical Exercise

Simulated editorial review process.

Session 2: Managing Revisions and Editorial Feedback

Topics

- Reading reviewer comments
- Writing response letters
- Revision strategies
- Publishing contracts and copyright

Practical Exercise

Respond to actual reviewer comments.

Assignment

Prepare a reviewer response matrix.

Expected Output

Reviewer response letter and revised manuscript section.

M3

RESEARCH IMPACT AND OPEN SCIENCE

2 Sessions 6–8 Hours

MODULE GOAL

To help researchers maximise visibility, accessibility, and impact of their research.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Understand open science principles
- Increase citation potential
- Build researcher profiles
- Track research impact
- Use repositories effectively

Session 1: Open Science and Open Access

Topics

- Open science principles
- Open-access publishing models
- Institutional repositories
- Data sharing practices

Practical Exercise

Deposit a paper into a repository.

Session 2: Measuring and Increasing Research Impact

Topics

- Citation metrics
- H-index and impact indicators
- Research visibility strategies
- Academic networking platforms (ORCID, Google Scholar, ResearchGate)

Practical Exercise

Create and optimise profiles on ORCID, Google Scholar, and ResearchGate.

Assignment

Develop a personal research visibility plan.

Expected Output

Research impact enhancement strategy.

M4

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION FOR POLICY IMPACT

3 Sessions 9–
12 Hours

MODULE GOAL

To strengthen participants' ability to translate research into policy and public influence.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Write policy briefs
- Develop evidence-based narratives
- Engage media effectively
- Communicate with non-specialist audiences
- Use storytelling for impact

Session 1: Principles of Knowledge Translation

Topics

- Research-to-policy pathways

- Audience analysis
- Evidence translation

Practical Exercise

Convert a research finding into a policy message.

Session 2: Writing Policy Briefs and Op-Eds

Topics

- Structure of policy briefs
- Writing executive summaries
- Op-ed development

Practical Exercise

Draft a two-page policy brief.

Session 3: Media Engagement and Storytelling

Topics

- Media interviews
- Press releases
- Storytelling techniques
- Social media for research dissemination

Practical Exercise

Mock media interview.

Assignment

- One policy brief
- One opinion article
- One media release

Expected Output

Policy communication package.

M5

ETHICAL PUBLISHING AND RESEARCH INTEGRITY

2 Sessions 6–8 Hours

MODULE GOAL

To promote responsible conduct in research and publishing.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Understand research ethics
- Avoid plagiarism
- Apply authorship standards
- Ensure transparency and reproducibility

Session 1: Research Integrity

Topics

- Research misconduct
- Fabrication and falsification
- Authorship ethics
- Conflicts of interest

Practical Exercise

Ethics case study analysis.

Session 2: Responsible Publishing

Topics

- Plagiarism detection
- Citation ethics
- Data transparency
- Reproducibility

Practical Exercise

Using plagiarism screening tools.

Assignment

Develop an ethical compliance checklist.

Expected Output

Research integrity action plan.

M6

RESPONSIBLE USE OF AI IN ACADEMIC WRITING AND PUBLISHING

2 Sessions 6–8 Hours

MODULE GOAL

To enable participants to use AI responsibly while maintaining academic integrity.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Use AI tools ethically
- Understand AI limitations
- Apply disclosure requirements
- Protect data privacy
- Maintain originality

Session 1: AI for Research and Writing

Topics

- AI tools landscape
- Literature review support
- Editing and language enhancement
- AI-assisted brainstorming

Practical Exercise

Compare AI-generated and human-written outputs.

Session 2: Ethics, Transparency and Governance

Topics

- AI disclosure requirements
- Journal policies on AI
- Data protection
- Bias and misinformation

Practical Exercise

Develop AI usage statements for manuscripts.

Assignment Prepare an AI-assisted writing workflow.	Expected Output <i>Responsible AI use protocol.</i>
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M7

LINKING RESEARCH TO THE SDGs

2 Sessions 6–8 Hours

MODULE GOAL To strengthen the alignment of research with global sustainable development priorities.	LEARNING OUTCOMES - Map research to SDGs - Develop impact pathways - Demonstrate policy relevance - Frame evidence for donors and policymakers
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Session 1: Understanding the SDG Framework	
Topics - SDGs overview - Targets and indicators - SDG localisation in Africa - Theory of Change	
Practical Exercise Map participant research to SDGs.	
Session 2: Demonstrating Development Impact	
Topics - Impact pathways - Results frameworks - Donor reporting - Policy influence tracking	
Practical Exercise Develop an SDG impact matrix.	
Assignment Prepare an SDG alignment and impact statement for a manuscript or policy product.	Expected Output <i>Research-to-SDG impact framework.</i>

CAPSTONE PROJECT (ACADEMY-WIDE)

Throughout the Academy, each participant develops one publication product, choosing from the following tracks:

Track A Academic Journal Manuscript	Track B Policy Brief	Track C Technical Paper	Track D Book Chapter
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Final Deliverables

- Publishable manuscript or policy product
- Journal submission package
- Policy communication package
- Research impact strategy
- SDG alignment statement

This capstone approach ensures that participants graduate from the Academy not only with knowledge but with a completed, publication-ready product and a clear pathway to publication and impact.

Africa Research and Impact Network (ARIN) | arin-africa.org | Taylor & Francis Group | taylorandfrancis.com
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